UPSC CSE Mains 2027 · GS Paper II

# INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

## World order · Major powers · Neighbourhood · Diaspora · Extended neighbourhood

**Handwritten-style notes**

Built from the Sarrthi IAS GS Mains Module (IR) handouts and class slides.
Bracket trees · diagrams · mnemonics · PYQ tags · current affairs
Right column and left binding margin are kept blank for your own use.

Personal study edition · for printing

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5 Extended neighbourhood ..... 30

# START HERE: HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

✎ *Read once with a pen. Fill the right column with your class notes. Before a test, cover the recall drill at the end of each chapter.*

How IR is asked (PPT-1, slide 3): 4 questions, 50 marks every year. Q9, Q10 = 10 marks / 150 words (~7 min). Q19, Q20 = 15 marks / 250 words (~11 min). Questions are broad and statement-based: test the claim, don't endorse it.

| Box | Means |
|---|---|
| Pink | slide line / handout error |
| Yellow | trap or rule for the exam hall |
| Green | ready conclusion line |
| Blue dashed | definition |
| Navy | current affairs (verify dates) |

## APPROACHES SHEET (your teacher's): pick one for the BODY

| No. | Approach | How to use | Best IR fit |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Stakeholder | impact, limits, way forward | "to what extent", policy questions |
| 2 | Supply chain | process | corridors: Chabahar → INSTC |
| 3 | GS Paper-wise | PESTEL | "examine influence / relations" |
| 4 | Level analysis | personal → national → international | diaspora, soft power, global role |
| 5 | Component | parts the question names | "diplomatic, economic, strategic" |
| 6 | SDGs | "sustainable" word | climate, Africa, island states |
| 7 | Syllabus | broad question | groupings, effect of policies |
| 8 | Demand / supply | need vs offer | minerals, energy, labour |
| 9 | P3I | people, powers, processes, infra | connectivity, regional engagement |
| 10 | Life cycle | birth → growth → crisis → reset | Maldives, Bangladesh |
| 11 | Temporal | timeline | "evolution", "post-Cold War" |
| 12 | SWOT | S, W, O, T | "importance + challenges", "pros and cons" |

Quick recall (teacher): Stakeholder → Supply Chain → GS Paper Wise → Level → Component → SDG → Syllabus → Demand/Supply → P3I → Life Cycle → Temporal → SWOT. Every answer: Intro (number / slide line / current hook) → Body (one approach) → Way forward → Conclusion (slide's closing phrase).

## WHICH LECTURE FEEDS WHICH CHAPTER

| Chapter | Class slides | Handout | Mains PYQs quoted |
|---|---|---|---|
| 🌐 1 World order & foreign policy | PPT-1, PPT-2 | Ch 1 pp. 1-21 | 2026 (4), 2025, 2020, 2019 |
| ⚡ 2 Major powers | PPT-3, PPT-4 (Other Powers) | Ch 2 pp. 1-24 | 2017-2026 (10) |
| 3 Neighbourhood | PPT-4 Neighbourhood | Ch 3 pp. 1-27 | 2024, 2022, 2015 (2) |
| 4 Diaspora | PPT-6 | merged pp. 72-77 | 2026, 2023, 2020, 2017 |
| 5 Extended neighbourhood | PPT-7.2, PPT-7 | merged pp. 78-100 | 2024, 2021 (2), 2018 (2), 2016, 2015 |
| 🌐 6 International organisations | slides pending | merged pp. 101-143 | to come |

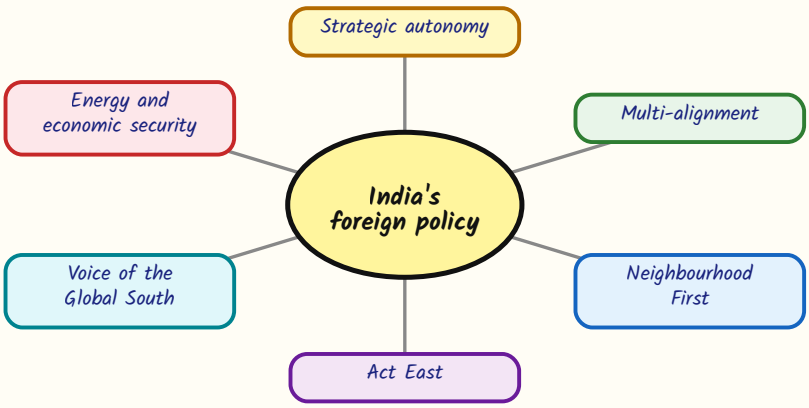
Sources: only your Sarrthi IAS handouts and class slides. The decks are typed (no handwriting), so "slide phrase" boxes quote the slides' own "core idea" and "conclusion" lines. Current-affairs boxes come from your July and August 2026 magazines (web items are marked). Mnemonics marked "own mnemonic" are not from class.

# WORLD ORDER & INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

PYQ Mains 2026 (x4) · 2025 · 2020 · 2019

✎ *The world moved through six phases of power and rules. India's foreign policy answers each phase, but one thread never breaks: strategic autonomy.*

## 👥 Pillars to remember




How IR is asked (slide 3): 4 questions, 50 marks every year: Q9 & Q10 (10m, 150w) + Q19 & Q20 (15m, 250w). Questions are broader now: a theme in a wider context; statement-based questions must be tested, not endorsed → write "agree in part, but...". ⭐

## TEACHER'S ORDER OF STUDY (slide 5)

1 · World order (this chapter) → 2 · Major powers: US, China, Russia → 3 · Bilaterals inside the big picture → 4 · Place any theme in context

**Basics**

→ IR = how countries interact with each other and with IOs, companies, movements, people. Core question: why do countries behave the way they do?
→ Foreign policy = what a country wants abroad and how it gets it
→ Geopolitics = how geography, location, resources shape power
→ Global order = how power, rules and institutions are arranged

## 🌐 SIX PHASES OF THE GLOBAL ORDER

| 1 · till 1914 | 2 · 1919-45 | 3 · 1945-91 | 4 · 1991-2008 | 5 · 2008-19 | 6 · 2020- |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Realism, BoP, empires | Liberal try fails | Cold War: 3 strands | Unipolar, globalisation | Crisis of liberalism | Fragmentation, churn |

Handout alert: tables say Phase 5 = 2008–2019; slide headings say "post-2008 till 2020". Rule: Phase 6 starts 2020 (post-COVID). The world did not move in a straight line: every phase mixed power, cooperation and ideas.

## PHASE 1 · REALISM (till WW I)

> *"A country that demands moral perfection in its foreign policy will achieve neither perfection nor security."* – Kissinger

**Westphalia**

→ Thirty Years' War 1618–48: religious + dynastic → shows danger of fragmented authority
→ Peace of Westphalia 1648 → state sovereignty + non-interference; base of modern international law
→ France, Sweden grew stronger

| Concept | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Sovereignty | supreme authority inside territory |
| Anarchy | NOT chaos: no world government above states |
| 🛡️ Security dilemma | A arms for defence → B feels threatened → both less secure |
| ⚡ Balance of Power | stop any one power dominating |

## THE REALISM FLOW (slide 7)

Anarchy → Self-help → Mistrust → Security dilemma → Arms race → Balance of Power

**Road to WW I**

→ "Attack first" belief → Schlieffen Plan
→ BoP could not prevent war; rival alliances
→ Trigger: Archduke Franz Ferdinand assassinated
→ Nehru: a "nervous state of peace" after the war

## PHASE 2 · LIBERAL TRY, REALISM WINS (1919–45)

Wilson's 14 Points 1918 → League of Nations 1920 (collective security) → Great Depression 1929: protectionism, dictators → League fails: Manchuria 1931, Abyssinia 1935 → WW II → Hiroshima, Nagasaki 1945

✅ Liberalism: war not inevitable; institutions, trade, democracy, law build cooperation without a world government.

💡 Collective security: all act against an aggressor; works only if major powers enforce it. Deterrence = capability + credibility + communication; MAD.

## PHASE 3 · COLD WAR (1945–91): THREE STRANDS

| Strand | Core idea | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| Liberalism | institutions → cooperation | UN 1945, IMF–WB, Marshall Plan (~$13 bn, also containment), NPT 1968 (→ SALT), Stockholm 1972, Schengen 1985; USSR: COMECON |
| Realism | rivalry, arms race | NATO 1949 vs Warsaw Pact 1955; Korea, Vietnam; Cuban Missile Crisis 1962; Yom Kippur 1973 → bipolarity |
| 💡 Idealism | peace, no blocs | NAM, Belgrade 1961; Nehru's strategic autonomy |

India exception: 1971 Indo-Soviet Treaty in the Bangladesh crisis; US sent USS Enterprise to the Bay of Bengal for Pakistan. Non-alignment ≠ no partners. ⭐

## PHASE 4 · UNIPOLAR MOMENT (1991–2008)

**Victory of liberalism**

→ USSR falls 1991 → US sole superpower; Poland, Baltics → NATO, EU; Yeltsin's privatisation
→ WTO 1995; China joins WTO 2001
→ US unilateralism: Afghanistan 2001, Iraq 2003 → overreach
→ Shared issues: Kyoto 1997 (→ Paris 2015), 9/11 terror, cyber
→ Multipolarity seeds: China, India, Brazil, Russia → BRICS

India's LPG 1991 (BoP crisis): GDP ~$270 bn (1991) → ~$1.2 tn (2008) → economics enters foreign policy. Unipolarity = one dominant power; hegemony = strong enough to write the rules. 📌

## 👫 PHASE 5 · CRISIS OF LIBERALISM (post-2008)

**🎯 Trends**

→ GFC 2008 → faith in Western order falls
→ Shift to Indo-Pacific: 2010 China passes Japan; Obama's Pivot to Asia; later Trump's America First
→ BRICS NDB 2014; G20 = crisis platform
→ Brexit 2016 (~52% leave); Syrian refugees (Germany 1 mn+, Hungary resists)
→ Protectionism: US–China trade war

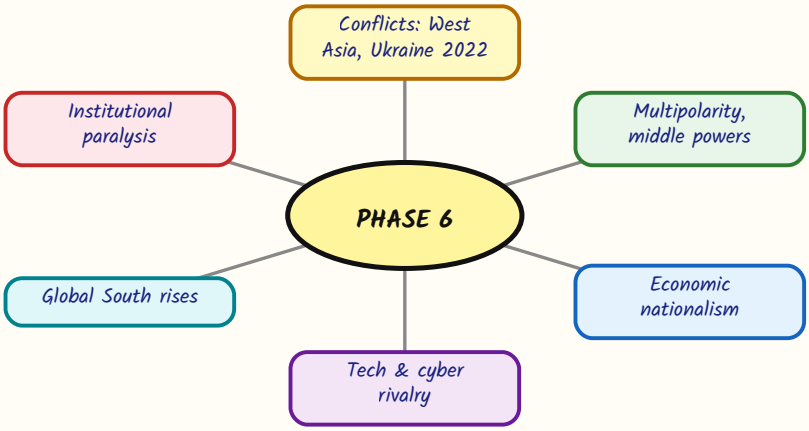
| China's rise | Detail |
|---|---|
| Economic-strategic | BRI 2013; Gwadar, Hambantota, CPEC → less Malacca dependence |
| Military | salami slicing, grey-zone, A2/AD, South China Sea, Taiwan |
| Tech | Made in China 2025 (2015); Huawei 5G |
| Institutional | BRICS, SCO, AIIB |

## US–CHINA RIVALRY SPREADS (slide 17)




Slide 17 "Overall": globalisation continued but became more political, protectionist and security-driven. ⭐

# 🎯 PHASE 6 · FRAGMENTATION (2020 onwards) PYQ 2025 · 2026




**1 Conflicts**

→ Israel–Hamas 2023–; Feb 2026 US–Israeli strikes on Iran killed Khamenei → proxy to direct state conflict

→ Russia–Ukraine 2022–; Russia vetoed UNSC resolution

**⚡ 2 Power shifts**

→ China: BRI + military; US: Quad + AUKUS

→ Middle powers: India, Brazil, Indonesia, Türkiye → issue-based coalitions, competitive multilateralism

→ India: multi-alignment, "strategic patience and calibrated engagement"

**3 Econ nationalism**

→ COVID → deglobalisation; SCRI (India–Japan–Australia); reshoring; friend-shoring, de-risking

→ US tariffs again (America First, 2025); Graham Act 2026: up to 100% tariffs on buyers of Russian oil

→ China curbs rare earths; India: Atmanirbhar Bharat

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Geoeconomics | trade, tariffs, sanctions, finance for strategic goals |
| Weaponised interdependence | use control of networks to pressure: SWIFT curbs on Russia, US chip controls on China |
| Transactional diplomacy | immediate bargains over shared values |
| Techno-nationalism | technology = national security |

**4–8**

→ Tech: AI, chips, export controls; India: human-centric AI ("fortune in AI")

→ Global South: G20 Indonesia 2022, India 2023, Brazil 2024, S. Africa 2025; AU in G20 (2023); G4, Ezulwini Consensus

→ Populism: America First, Brothers of Italy, National Rally, AfD

→ Climate = threat multiplier: Nepal glacier 2026, Cyclone Mocha 2023

→ Paralysis: UNSC veto; WTO Appellate Body no quorum → "selective multilateralism"

## ESSENCE OF THE PHASE (slide 21) = your intro line




| Area | US-led | China-backed |
|---|---|---|
| 💰 Development finance | IMF / WB | AIIB / NDB |
| Connectivity | PGII / IMEC | BRI / CPEC |
| 💰 Finance | Dollar, SWIFT | Yuan, alt payments |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Tech | US AI, chips | Chinese 5G |

Slide 23: China has not replaced the US-led order; minilaterals (Quad, SCO, I2U2, BRICS+) supplement, not replace institutions. ✅

In the news · Aug 2026 CA US tariff on India: 25% reciprocal + 25% for Russian oil = 50% (2025); Feb 2026 interim framework → 18% vs ~3% historic average. A partner punished for an energy choice = waning globalisation.

In the news · Jul-Aug 2026 CA Mecca Joint Defence Agreement (Saudi-Türkiye-Pakistan): strategic hedging, but no command, no text, no common enemy = not an alliance. UAE left OPEC (May 2026). Five states leaving the ICC.

## ⏳ INDIA: GOALS & 10 DETERMINANTS

Three constant goals: security, prosperity, an independent voice (strategic autonomy). Policy shifts with global order, security, economic needs, ambitions. 💡

| Determinant | Aim | Example (slides 3–7) |
|---|---|---|
| 1 Economy | markets, FDI, tech, energy, supply chains | China+1; Chabahar, INSTC, IMEC |
| 🛡️ 2 Security | China, Pak borders; terror; maritime, cyber | LAC; oppose CPEC |
| 3 Geography | Himalaya; Pak blocks land route; Indian Ocean | Malacca; Chabahar; A&N |
| 4 Strategic autonomy | pragmatism, multi-alignment, no rigid alliance | Quad + Russia |
| 5 Energy, minerals | diversify, no over-dependence | Critical Mineral Mission 2025 |
| 6 S&T | AI, chips, space, quantum, defence tech | India-US tech; India-France space |
| 🏛️ 7 Values, history | anti-colonial, sovereign equality, reform | UNSC reform |
| 🗺️ 8 Domestic, federal | states shape policy | TN: Lankan Tamils; WB: Teesta; NE |
| 🎯 9 Diaspora PYQ 2026 | asset + consular duty | Ganga 2022, Kaveri 2023, Sindhu 2025 |
| ⚠️ 10 Climate, new issues | climate finance, health, AI, oceans, space | ISA, CDRI, Mission LiFE |

**E S G S E S P D D C** – "Every Smart Guy Sees Energy, Science, Politics, Domestic Diaspora Climate" – in the slide order. (own mnemonic) 📌

In the news · Jul 2026 CA PACTS with Australia = India's 3rd tech-trust pact after TRUST (US) and TSI (UK). Hormuz disruption → LPG worries in India: determinant 5 live.

## 🌐 SIX PERIODS OF INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

| Period | Approach | Markers |
|---|---|---|
| 1947–62 | Non-alignment, idealism | Panchsheel, NAM, "normative idealism" |
| 1962–71 | Security correction | 1962, 1965 wars → defence; idealism stays, realism grows |
| 1971–91 | Strategic assertion | 1971 Treaty, Bangladesh, Pokhran-I 1974 |
| 1991–98 | Economic opening | LPG, Look East, Gujral Doctrine (trust + non-reciprocity + sovereignty) |
| 1998–2014 | Diversified partnerships | Pokhran-II 1998, India-US nuclear deal, G20, BRICS |
| 2014– | Multi-alignment | Quad + BRICS + SCO; AIIB; Russian oil; S-400 despite CAATSA; "bridge power" |

## CENTRAL THREAD: STRATEGIC AUTONOMY (slide 21)

Non-alignment → Strategic partnerships → Multi-alignment → Issue-based cooperation

Trap: Gujral Doctrine = 1991–98, neighbourhood. Panchsheel, NAM = 1947–62. Don't mix. 📌

## 🎯 CONTINUITY, CHANGE, TRADE-OFFS PYQ 2019

| Then | Now |
|---|---|
| Non-alignment | Multi-alignment |
| Distance from blocs | Engage many centres |
| Political autonomy | Econ + tech + security autonomy |
| Aid recipient | Development partner |
| Rule-taker | Rule-shaper |

✅ Handout line (p. 17): it is not a shift from values to interests. India keeps its values but now has more capability to protect interests.

Continuities: strategic autonomy, national interest, sovereignty (oppose CPEC via PoK), Global South, dialogue, Neighbourhood First. 💡

| 5 trade-offs | Example |
|---|---|
| Autonomy vs deeper alignment | Quad + Russian oil |
| China: compete vs engage | LAC vs BRICS, SCO |
| 🛡️ Neighbour sensitivity vs security | Maldives, Nepal, Sri Lanka |
| ⚡ Global South vs major powers | US, EU, Japan ties |
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 Principles vs hard interest | Ukraine dialogue + Russian energy |

⚠️ 7 challenges (constraints, not trade-offs)

→ Old institutions (UNSC, IMF, WB)
→ Domestic capability gaps
→ External shocks: COVID, Ukraine, Red Sea
→ South Asia least integrated
→ Tech dependence
→ Thin diplomatic cadre
→ Credibility: ambition vs delivery

📰 In the news · Jul 2026 CA Multi-alignment in practice (July 2026): summits with Australia (inside AUKUS), Japan (sanctions Russia), Indonesia (ties with China, Russia) while India keeps Russia ties. "Multi-alignment buys options; every partner has a reservation."

## INSTRUMENTS: "THE INDIA WAY" (handout only)

Toolbox

→ Geoeconomics: energy diversification, China+1, critical minerals, Chabahar–INSTC–IMEC, DPI/UPI, lines of credit
→ China: deterrence + de-risking + competition + selective engagement
→ Indian Ocean: net security provider, MDA, HADR; SAGAR → MAHASAGAR
→ Minilaterals: Quad, I2U2, India–France–UAE, BRICS, SCO, G20, ISA/CDRI → supplement, not replace
→ Soft power: yoga, Buddhism, diaspora, evacuations; works only with delivery

String of Pearls (China): Gwadar, Hambantota, Djibouti base ⭐

Diamond Necklace (India): Chabahar, Duqm, Sabang ✅

*Key words:* Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam · Vishwabandhu · Voice of the Global South · reformed multilateralism · net security provider · first responder

📰 **In the news · Jul–Aug 2026 CA** UNSC campaign for 2028–29 under SHANTI; India-hosted BRICS 2026 (Guwahati Declaration). Use for "multilateralism" and the 2026 BRICS question.

## 🎯 PYQ ANSWER FRAMES

| PYQ | Approach | Body |
|---|---|---|
| 🌐 2025 sovereign nationalism after globalisation | Temporal | Phase 4 → 5 → 6; tariffs, friend-shoring, Brexit, populism |
| 🆕 2026 Q10 BRICS as counterweight | Component | NDB, Global South voice, alt payments → limits (China, India differences) |
| 2020 Quad: military → trade bloc? | Temporal | security origin → SCRI, tech, supply chains → verdict: both |
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 2019 India lost leader-of-oppressed image? | Level analysis | NAM legacy → Global South 2023 (AU in G20) → "values + capability" |

## Recall drill: cover and answer

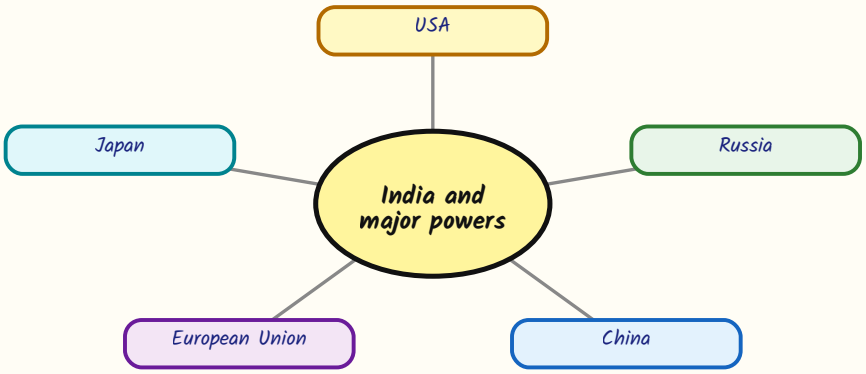
| | |
|---|---|
| Westphalia gave which two principles? | Sovereignty, non-interference (1648) |
| Realism flow? | Anarchy → self-help → mistrust → dilemma → arms race → BoP |
| Three Cold War strands? | Liberalism, Realism, Idealism (NAM 1961) |
| China overtook Japan / BRI / NDB? | 2010 / 2013 / 2014 |
| Phase 6 essence? | Rivalry → realignment → fragmentation → multipolarity → paralysis |
| Weaponised interdependence example? | SWIFT curbs; chip controls |
| Ten determinants? | ESGSESPDDC |
| Six periods? | 47–62, 62–71, 71–91, 91–98, 98–2014, 2014– |
| Gujral Doctrine? | Trust + non-reciprocity + sovereignty; 1991–98 |
| String of Pearls vs Diamond Necklace? | Gwadar, Hambantota, Djibouti vs Chabahar, Duqm, Sabang |

# MAJOR POWERS & INDIA

PYQ Mains 2026 · 2024 · 2023 · 2021 · 2020 (x2) · 2019 (x2) · 2018 · 2017

✎ *The US, China and Russia shape the choices of every other country. India partners widely, aligns selectively and depends permanently on none.*

## The big five relationships




*"International politics, like all politics, is a struggle for power."* – Hans Morgenthau

Major power = significant economic, technological, military capability + strategic intent to shape the order; influences many regions and institutions through deterrence, agenda-setting, interdependence. 💡

| Response | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Balancing | oppose the dominant power |
| Bandwagoning | align with the stronger one: Belarus–Russia, Pakistan–China |
| Strategic autonomy | decide alone (India) |

Slide 2 core idea: "Major powers shape the choices available to other countries." ⭐

Strategic entente = informal understanding to align or consult, not a formal alliance (e.g. Russia–China). ✅

## ⚡ THREE POWERS: AMBITIONS & INSTRUMENTS

| | USA | CHINA | RUSSIA |
|---|---|---|---|
| Goal | keep global leadership; burden-sharing by allies | "Middle Kingdom"; primacy via multipolarity | Eurasian influence; non-Western multipolar order |
| 1 | Regional balance: NATO, Quad, I2U2, AUKUS; forward presence; 2026 NDS island chain Japan → Taiwan → Philippines → Borneo | National rejuvenation: Made in China 2025; AI, chips, EVs | Multipolarity: BRICS, SCO, EAEU; BRICS Bridge (alt finance) |
| 2 | Tech-economic edge: tariffs, sanctions, export controls; CHIPS Act 2022; Graham Act 2026 (up to 100%); IPEF, friend-shoring | Regional reach: BRI, CPEC, Gwadar; A2/AD; Two-Ocean strategy; Djibouti | Eurasia: CSTO; nuclear doctrine; "nuclear power sustains influence beyond economic weight" |
| 3 | Finance & institutions: dollar, UN, IMF, WB, G20 | Tech leadership: "New Three" = EVs, Li-ion batteries, solar PV; rare-earth controls | Energy leverage: oil to China, India; shadow tanker fleet beats G7 price cap |
| 4 | Western Hemisphere: renewed Monroe Doctrine; Op Absolute Resolve (Venezuela) | Global governance: BRICS, SCO, AIIB; GDI, GSI, GCI; Saudi-Iran deal 2023 | Connectivity: Northern Sea Route; eastward pivot; Russia-N. Korea treaty |

Slide 7: "US power is not only military: also financial, institutional, technological." The US is turning interest-driven and transactional. ⭐

Thin notes: AUKUS, Pax Silica, "Mythos 5", Op Absolute Resolve are only named in the handout. Don't invent details. 📌

## 🎯 US-CHINA RIVALRY PYQ 2017 · 2024

Power Transition Theory: conflict likelier 💡 when a rising power nears the dominant one.
Thucydides Trap: the risk when a rising power threatens an established one.

Slide 13: "Not a complete new Cold War ⭐ because economic interdependence continues." Slide 12: "Technology has become a national-security issue."

**7 dimensions**

→ Military: SCS, W. Pacific; US allies Japan, S. Korea, Australia, Philippines
→ Taiwan: chips; US arms sales; China's Justice Mission 2025
→ Tech: chip export controls; Sept 2026 Trump-Xi summit proposed AI dialogue
→ Supply chains: de-risking; China curbs gallium, germanium, rare earths
→ Economic: Washington vs Beijing Consensus; truce + tariff cuts on $30 bn each way
→ Institutions: US alliances vs BRI, AIIB, BRICS, SCO
→ Global: Global South matters more; ASEAN hedges

| Impact on India | |
|---|---|
| Indo-Pacific | Chinese IOR presence → Quad, IORA matter |
| Border | LAC sharper; more partner cooperation |
| Supply chains | China+1 chance, but Chinese inputs a risk |
| Autonomy | multi-alignment needed |
| Governance | blocks UNSC/WTO reform; India as Global South bridge |

## 🎯 RUSSIA-WEST CONFRONTATION PYQ 2023

> *"The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting."* – Sun Tzu

**Since Ukraine 2022**

→ NATO grows: Finland 2023, Sweden 2024; Ankara Summit 2026: €70 bn for Ukraine
→ Sanctions: EU July 2026 package (energy, shadow fleet)
→ Energy: EU dependence on Russian gas 45% (2021) → 12% (2025); Jan 2026 phase-out Regulation
→ Hybrid/cyber warfare
→ Russia-China "No Limits": trade ~$228 bn (2025); shared interests, not an alliance
→ Global South avoids choosing

| Impact on India | |
|---|---|
| Defence | spares, MRO risk → diversify, indigenise |
| Energy | Russian crude vital; Graham Act a challenge |
| Autonomy | balance Russia with US-EU ties |
| Connectivity | INSTC hit; Central Asia, Iran routes |
| Triangle | Russia-China closeness shrinks India's Eurasian space |

Slide 15: "The world is not divided into two fixed blocs." Never accept "new Cold War" or "two blocs" without this qualifier. ⭐

# INDIA'S APPROACH

## JAISHANKAR, "THE INDIA WAY": the opening line for any bilateral answer

ENGAGE America → MANAGE China → CULTIVATE Europe → REASSURE Russia → BRING Japan into play → DRAW neighbours in

Handout core idea (p. 7): strategic autonomy under pressure: partnering widely, aligning selectively, depending permanently on none. US → tech, defence, Indo-Pacific · China → deterrence + engagement · Russia → defence, energy, Eurasia. ✅

## 🎯 INDIA-CHINA PYQ 2026 BRI · 2017

Slide 17: competition + interdependence + selective cooperation = managed competition. ⭐

| Phase | Keyword | Markers |
|---|---|---|
| 1950–54 | Postcolonial engagement | PRC recognised 1949; ties 1950; Panchsheel 1954 |
| 1950s–62 | Territorial rupture | Tibet; 1962 war; Aksai Chin lost |
| 1976–88 | Rapprochement | Rajiv Gandhi visit 1988 |
| 1993–2005 | Border management | 1993–96 pacts; SR mechanism 2003; 2005 principles |
| 2008–13 | Economic engagement | trade up, imbalance wider |
| 2017–20 | Confrontation | Doklam 2017; Galwan 2020 |
| 2020–24 | Crisis management | Corps Commander, WMCC; Depsang–Demchok Oct 2024 |
| 🆕 2025–26 | Calibrated re-engagement | SR, WMCC, flights, visas |

**P–T–D–I–E–B–C–C** — Postcolonial → Territorial → Diplomatic → Institutional → Economic → Border → Crisis → Calibrated. (own mnemonic, in order) 📌

**Convergence**

- → BRICS, NDB, AIIB
- → Trade $151 bn (2025–26)
- → WTO: public stockholding, SSM
- → Climate: CBDR-RC
- → Multipolar order
- → Kailash Mansarovar Yatra, flights

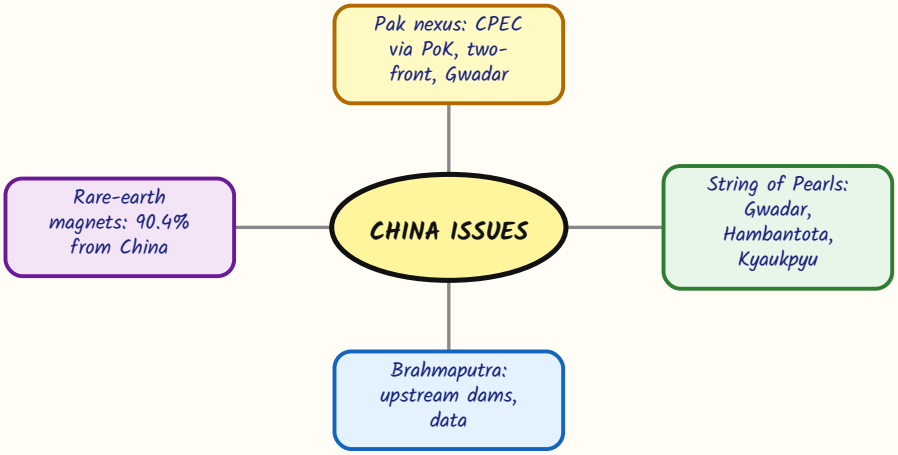
**Divergence**

- → Border: Doklam, Galwan; Arunachal names
- → BRI, CPEC, IOR presence
- → Global South rivalry: GDI, GSI
- → Deficit ~$112.16 bn (FY26)
- → Rare earths, graphite, telecom
- → Brahmaputra upstream; Tibet (Dalai Lama succession, July 2025)

| Sector | Length | Key points |
|---|---|---|
| Western (Ladakh) | 1,597 km | Aksai Chin under China; Galwan 2020; Depsang–Demchok 2024 |
| Middle (HP, Uttarakhand) | 545 km | least disputed |
| Eastern (Sikkim, Arunachal) | 1,346 km | McMahon Line; Doklam tri-junction |

**Total 3,488 km** = 1,597 + 545 + 1,346; not fully demarcated. **Trap:** Doklam = 2017, EAST; Galwan = 2020, WEST.

## ⚠ FOUR CHINA ISSUE BOXES (slide 22)




**Details**

→ **Pak nexus:** China aided Pak ISR in the May conflict; Gwadar = "potential maritime dimension", **not automatically a naval base**
→ **Pearls → India:** MDA, naval logistics, SAGAR/MAHASAGAR, Quad
→ **River:** independent monitoring; coordinate with **Bangladesh**
→ **Magnets:** April 2025 China licenses **7 heavy rare earths**; India imports all sintered NdFeB; demand **8,220 t/yr by 2030** → **₹7,280-crore scheme, 6,000 t** capacity

**Close: the Three Mutuals** = mutual respect + mutual sensitivity + mutual interests. ✅
Combine **dialogue with deterrence, engagement with de-risking.**

*In the news · Aug 2026 CA* **25th SR talks:** 8-point consensus: 2 more military meeting points + 2 hotlines; Expert Group on Boundary Delimitation; Working Group on Border Management; more Kailash yatra batches. Modi–Xi met at the **18th BRICS Summit**, New Delhi (12 Sep 2026, web).

## 🎯 INDIA–US: "PARTNERSHIP, NOT ALLIANCE" PYQ 2019 · 2020 · 2024

| 1947–60s | 1962 | 1971 | 1998–2005 | 2005–08 | 2016–20 | 2021– | 2025–26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| caution; US–Pak | brief help | mistrust: tilt to Pak | Pokhran-II → Talbott talks | nuclear deal | LEMOA, COMCASA, BECA | Quad, iCET → TRUST | COMPACT, Mission 500, 10-yr defence |

**Convergence**

→ Indo-Pacific: Quad, **Malabar**
→ Defence: LEMOA 2016, BECA 2020; trade ~$25 bn (2023)
→ Tech: **iCET → TRUST**, INDUS-X
→ Space: **NISAR**; Artemis Accords 2023
→ Trade ~$149.4 bn (2025); **Mission 500 by 2030**
→ Diaspora: 1.5% of US, $300 bn+ taxes, 82% STEM

**Divergence**

→ Russia: S-400, oil, **CAATSA**
→ Tariffs: **25% + 25% → 18%** (2026 deal); GSP removed 2019
→ Digital: Special 301 list; data localisation
→ Pakistan: **re-hyphenation**, mediation
→ H-1B: Indians 71% (FY24)
→ Climate: US left Paris (2026)

| India SEEKS | India AVOIDS |
|---|---|
| defence interoperability | treaty alliance |
| 💰 technology access | technology dependence |
| joint exercises | automatic war commitments |
| maritime cooperation | foreign military bases |
| Quad, minilaterals | formal anti-China bloc |
| closer US defence ties | forced abandonment of Russia |

Close (slide 29): from estrangement to strategic convergence; strategic pragmatism: US capital, tech, innovation + autonomy. ✅

📰 In the news · Aug 2026 CA Trade US$239 bn (FY25), Indian surplus; US = 1st export market, 3rd investor. Frictions: 18% tariff vs 3% norm, SPS/MRL barriers. Fix: Bilateral Trade Agreement, Mission 500 roadmap, diversify.

## 🎯 INDIA-RUSSIA PYQ 2020 defence deals

| 1947 | 1960s | 1971 | 1975 | 1988 | 2000 | 2010 | 2021 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ties | MiG-21 | Treaty | Aryabhata | Kudankulam | Strategic Partnership | Special & Privileged | first 2+2 |

**Convergence**

- → UNSC + NSG support; BRICS, SCO, RIC
- → Su-30MKI, T-90, S-400, AK-203, Vikramaditya; MRO
- → Crude 1.92 mn b/d, 36.5% (May 2026)
- → Trade $68.7 bn (FY25)
- → $100 bn by 2030
- → Kudankulam; Rooppur (B'desh)
- → INSTC, Chennai-Vladivostok; Gaganyaan

**Divergence**

- → Russia-China proximity
- → Quad seen with suspicion
- → S-400 delays, spares, payments
- → Trade gap: out $4.3 bn, in $61.4 bn (2023-24)
- → Russia-Pakistan engagement
- → weak in AI, chips, digital

Triangle: India needs Russia to keep enough strategic space in Eurasia, without expecting it to balance China. Use Chabahar, INSTC, SCO.

Close (slide 36): from a defence-and-energy anchor to a diversified partnership (tech, minerals, Eurasian connectivity). Fix: India-EAEU FTA, Make-in-India co-production, local-currency payments. ✅

## 🎯 EUROPE: EU & FRANCE PYQ 2023 NATO

**EU**

→ Trade + Technology + Climate (slide 2)

→ 1994 pact; 2004 SP; FTA talks 2007, stall 2013; TTC 2022

→ FTA concluded 2026 ("Mother of All Deals"): 99.5% of exports; dairy, cereals, poultry out

→ Goods $136.54 bn + services $83.10 bn (2024–25)

→ Friction: CBAM, GDPR, AI Act, standards as NTBs, Ukraine

**France**

→ Strategic trust + autonomy + Indo-Pacific (slide 7)

→ Horizon 2047 (2023); Special Global Strategic Partnership (Feb 2026)

→ 36 Rafale + 26 Rafale-M (Apr 2025); 6 Scorpene/ Kalvari (P-75)

→ Jaitapur 6 EPRs; ISA 2015; first EU country to take UPI

→ Varuna, Garuda, Shakti; Tata-Airbus H125 line

France direction (slide 8): buyer-seller → co-production; traditional → technology and innovation. ⭐

## 🎯 JAPAN & AUSTRALIA PYQ 2019 Japan

**Japan**

→ Strategic trust + economy + Indo-Pacific (slide 10)

→ ODA → private investment; JPY 10 tn target; FDI $40 bn+

→ Delhi Metro, DFC, bullet train; Act East Forum

→ JIMEX, Dharma Guardian; ACSA; SCRI; LUPEX

→ Gap: trade $27.47 bn, CEPA underused, slow projects, little tech transfer

**Australia**

→ "Southern Indo-Pacific anchor" (slide 13)

→ Trade A$50.2 bn; ECTA → CECA

→ Critical Minerals Corridor; uranium under IAEA (2026)

→ PACTS (2026); Malabar, AUSINDEX, AUSTRAHIND

→ Gap: CECA farm issues; China refines minerals; diaspora strains

Closes: Japan → convert convergence into economic, industrial, technological cooperation. Australia → from convergence to an operational partnership. ✅

## 🎯 PYQ ANSWER FRAMES

| PYQ | Approach | Body |
|---|---|---|
| 🆕 2026 BRI made S. Asia a theatre | Level analysis | Neighbours (CPEC, Hambantota) → India security → regional influence → response |
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 2024 West fosters India vs China | Stakeholder | US, EU, Japan, India gains → limits (autonomy) |
| 2023 NATO expansion good for India? | SWOT | stronger West, tech vs Russia squeeze, energy → "agree in part" |
| 2020 US vs Russia defence deals | Component | tech, interoperability vs legacy, spares → Indo-Pacific stability |
| 2019 US can't place India | Temporal | 1971 → 2008 → seeks/avoids table |
| 2019 India-Japan | Component | strategic, economic, tech → gaps → convert |

## Recall drill: cover and answer

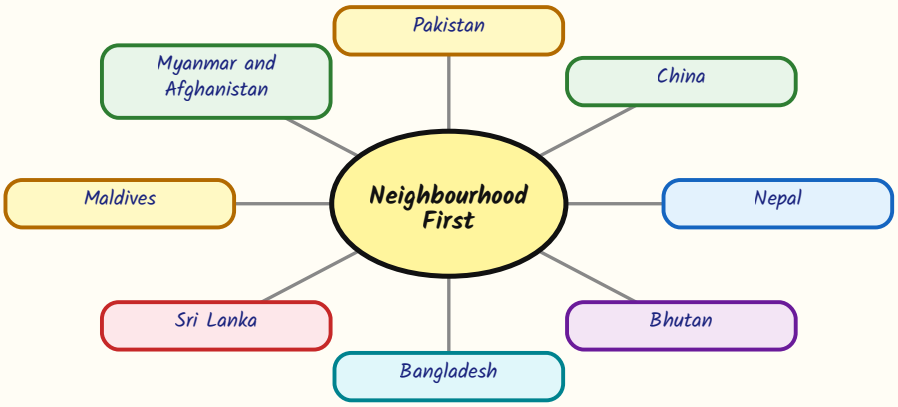
| | |
|---|---|
| Bandwagoning examples? | Belarus–Russia, Pakistan–China |
| China's "New Three"? | EVs, Li-ion batteries, solar PV |
| Russia's alt finance idea? | BRICS Bridge |
| Two core ideas against "new Cold War"? | Interdependence continues; not two fixed blocs |
| EU gas from Russia 2021 → 2025? | 45% → 12% |
| Border sectors? | 1,597 / 545 / 1,346 = 3,488 km |
| Rare-earth magnet scheme? | ₹7,280 crore, 6,000 t; China 90.4% |
| Three Mutuals? | Respect, sensitivity, interests |
| US tariff path? | 25% + 25% = 50% → 18% (2026) |
| Russia crude share May 2026? | 1.92 mn b/d, 36.5% |
| India–EU FTA coverage? | 99.5% of exports; dairy out |
| Australia role? | Southern Indo-Pacific anchor; PACTS, CECA |

# INDIA'S NEIGHBOURHOOD

PYQ Mains 2024 Maldives · 2022 Sri Lanka · 2015 Mausam · 2015 India-Pak soft power

✎ *Geography ties India to its neighbours for ever. Politics and security decide whether that closeness brings cooperation or friction.*

## Who is in the neighbourhood







*India and its neighbours (handout p. 1, slide 3)*

**India's interests (slide 4)**

→ **Security:** terror (Pak), insurgency (Myanmar), Afghan instability

→ **Trade, connectivity:** B'desh → NE; Myanmar → SE Asia (Kaladan, Trilateral Highway)

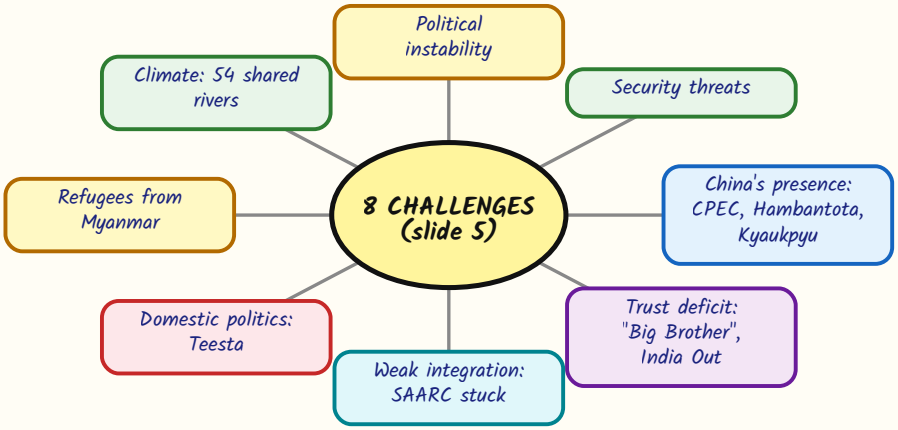
→ **Energy:** Bhutan, Nepal hydropower

→ **External influence:** China

→ **People:** open border, Buddhism

→ **Stability:** disasters, sea lanes

Slide 4: "Neighbourhood First prioritises physical, digital and people-to-people connectivity, trade and commerce." Slide 5: "Geography creates permanent interdependence, but politics and security determine whether it produces cooperation or friction." ⭐



🔧 Way forward (slide 6)

→ Respect sovereignty: equal partners
→ Security cooperation; Vibrant Villages for border communities
→ Project delivery = credibility
→ Economic integration: border haats, Nepal–B'desh power via India; BBIN, BIMSTEC
→ Climate data-sharing; people-centric diplomacy that survives regime change

Closing line (slide 6): combine the Gujral Doctrine (1996) (non-reciprocity, non-interference, sovereignty, peaceful settlement) with Neighbourhood First → trust rather than dependence. ✅

| Pre-1947 | 1947–49 | 1950s–60s | 1962–65 | 1970s–80s | 1991–96 | 1997–2013 | 2014– |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| imperial buffers | Partition | NAM, Panchsheel | security recalibration | 1971, SAARC 1985, Cactus 1988 | Look East, Gujral | BIMSTEC, IORA 1997 | Neighbourhood First |

PYQ Lab note: only 4 of 40 IR questions (2017–26) named a neighbour, each after a crisis next door. Prepare themes (crisis response, connectivity, water, China factor) with countries as examples. 📌

## ⚡ PAKISTAN: "STRUCTURAL RIVALRY" PYQ 2015 soft power

Slide phrase: Credible deterrence + escalation control + limited functional engagement (slide 8). ⭐

| 1947–65 | 1971–84 | 1998–2007 | 2008–14 | 2014–19 | 2021 | 2025–26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kashmir wars; IWT 1960; Tashkent | Shimla 1972; Meghdoot 1984 | nukes; Lahore, Kargil, 2003 ceasefire | Mumbai | Uri → surgical strikes; Pulwama → Balakot | ceasefire renewed | Pahalgam, Op Sindoor, IWT abeyance |

**Still open**

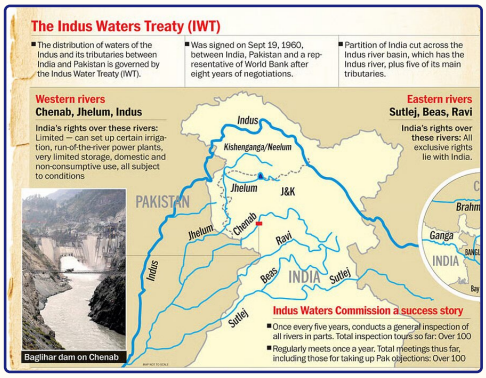
→ 2003 ceasefire, DGMO line; May 2025 stop-firing
→ 1988 pact: nuclear-site lists every year
→ 2008 consular pact: prisoner lists twice a year
→ 1974 Shrines Protocol; Kartarpur 2019 (suspended 2025)
→ SCO (Islamabad CHG 2024); SAARC stuck

**Divergence**

→ Terror: LeT, JeM; drones, cyber
→ J&K integral; no third-party mediation (Shimla)
→ Siachen: authenticate AGPL; Sir Creek
→ CPEC via PoK; two-front
→ IWT in abeyance (Apr 2025); Attari ICP closed
→ Stability–instability paradox




Sir Creek (handout p. 5)




IWT 1960 graphic (handout p. 5)

IWT (19 Sep 1960, World Bank): Western = Indus, Jhelum, Chenab → Pakistan; India limited use (run-of-river). Eastern = Ravi, Beas, Sutlej → India. Commission meets once a year. Disputes: Kishanganga, Ratle.

Close: deterrence with escalation control now; humanitarian channels (fishermen, prisoners, pilgrims) insulated; durable peace needs a terror-free environment. ✅

## AFGHANISTAN: "ENGAGEMENT WITHOUT ENDORSEMENT"

| to 1950 | 1979–2001 | 2001–14 | 2015–16 | 2021 | 2022–25 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Gandhara; 1950 Treaty | no Taliban recognition; Northern Alliance | development; 2011 SPA | Parliament, Salma Dam, Zaranj–Delaram | Op Devi Shakti | Technical Mission, Kabul |

**Convergence**

→ High Impact Community Projects; people-centric not regime-centric

→ Trade ~$907.85 mn (FY26); Chabahar bypasses Pak; Shahid Beheshti 2024 deal

→ UNSC Res 2593: Afghan soil not against others

→ Cricket, Kabuliwala, scholarships

**Divergence**

→ No recognition; women's rights; minorities

→ ISIL-K, Al-Qaeda, LeT/JeM; Death Crescent opiates

→ No land route; Iran sanctions hit Chabahar

→ China: Mes Aynak copper




Chabahar → Zaranj-Delaram → Ring Road (handout p. 8)

Close (slide 17): engagement without recognition, people-level goodwill, counter-terrorism and connectivity; small, locally maintainable projects. ✅

## BANGLADESH: "STRATEGIC RESET"

From "Sonali Adhyay" to reset. Longest land border 4,096 km; link to the Northeast; Bay of Bengal security. 💡

| 1971–72 | 1975–2008 | 2009–14 | 2014–15 | 2021–23 | 2024 | 2025–26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Liberation; Friendship Treaty | distrust; Ganga Treaty 1996 | Hasina: anti-insurgency | maritime award; LBA 2015 | Kushiyara; Akhaura–Agartala; pipeline | Hasina exits | reset |

**Convergence**

→ Biggest S. Asian trade partner: $14.01 bn (FY24)

→ Chattogram, Mongla transit; 40 MW Nepal power via India (Nov 2024); diesel pipeline 1 MMT/yr

→ Ganga 1996; Kushiyara 153 cusecs; 54 rivers (JRC)

→ LBA: 111 + 51 enclaves; SAMPRITI

**Divergence**

→ Hasina extradition request renewed (Aug 2026); minorities; Rohingya

→ Teesta unsettled (draft 2011); Ganga Treaty expires Dec 2026

→ 864 km unfenced; border deaths

→ 2025 import, land-port curbs; trans-shipment withdrawn (Apr 2025)

→ China: submarine facility

Fix: time-bound Teesta talks with West Bengal; post-2026 Ganga deal; CEPA; clear notice before trade curbs; BBIN energy. Geography, rivers, security stay permanent. ✅

## NEPAL: "ROTI-BETI & OPEN BORDER"

Slide phrase: civilisational, people-centred; HIT formula = Highways, I-ways, Trans-ways. Closeness also breeds mistrust. ⭐

| 1816 / 1950 | 1989 | 1996 | 2015 | 2020 | 2024–25 | 2025–26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sugauli; 1950 Treaty | trade-transit crisis | Mahakali | Op Maitri; Madhesi "blockade" | new map | 10,000 MW pact | youth-led change |

**Convergence**

→ Largest partner: $9.39 bn; 82%+ of Nepal's exports; UPI-NPI

→ Jaynagar–Bijalpura rail; ICPs; Motihari–Amlekhgunj pipeline

→ 10,000 MW export deal; Arun-III 900 MW

→ Koshi 1954, Gandak 1959, Mahakali 1996

→ Surya Kiran; Gorkha regiments; GLOF relief 130 t+

**Divergence**

→ Kalapani, Lipulekh, Limpiyadhura (2020 map)

→ 1950 Treaty "unequal"; EPG 2018 report pending

→ Agnipath vs 1947 Tripartite pact

→ BRI framework (Dec 2024)

→ Pancheshwar DPR stuck

Fix: review 1950 Treaty; evidence-based boundary talks (B'desh LBA as model); smart open border; Track-II; respect Nepal's balancing. ✅

## BHUTAN: "BHARAT FOR BHUTAN, BHUTAN FOR BHARAT"

**Story**

→ 1949 Treaty → Op All Clear 2003 → 2007 Treaty (more autonomy) → Doklam 2017 (Siliguri) → diversification

→ Trade ₹12,669 cr (2024); 55%+ of FDI; 2016 trade-transit pact

→ ₹10,000 cr for 13th Plan (2024-29)

→ 5 hydro projects 3,156 MW; Punatsangchhu-II 1,020 MW (2025); ₹4,000-cr LoC (Jul 2026)

→ IMTRAT; RuPay, UPI QR; India-Bhutan satellite 2022; first Vaccine Maitri country




*Gelephu Mindfulness City, near Assam*

**⚠ Issues**

→ Bhutan-China talks near Doklam

→ BBIN MVA not ratified

→ Punatsangchhu-I delays; 60-70% loans

→ India ~80% of trade

→ 2013 LPG subsidy row

Close: move beyond hydropower; Kokrajhar-Gelephu & Banarhat-Samtse rail; sovereignty-first consultation on Doklam. ✅

## MYANMAR: "CALIBRATED ENGAGEMENT"

Slide phrase: Myanmar tests India's ability to balance values, security and connectivity (slide 33). Not whether to engage, but with whom. ⭐

**Convergence**

→ Trade $2.15 bn (2024-25); Rupee-Kyat (May 2024)

→ Kaladan: Kolkata-Sittwe-Mizoram; Trilateral Highway; BIMSTEC, MGC

→ Op Brahma (Mar 2025 quake)

→ Ananda Temple, Bagan; 2 mn of Indian origin

**Divergence**

→ 1,643 km border; Death Triangle; FMR curbs opposed in Mizoram, Naga areas

→ Post-2021 refugees; Rakhine, Rohingya

→ China: Kyaukphyu port

→ Sittwe got first cargo 2023, corridor unfinished

→ values vs national interest

## 🎯 SRI LANKA PYQ 2022

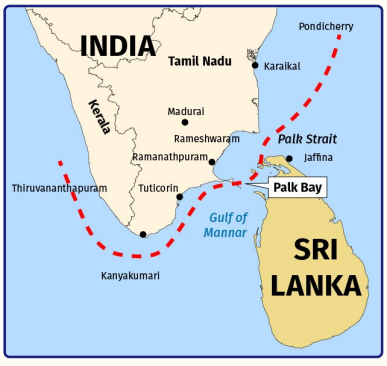
**Story**

→ Sirimavo-Shastri Pact → 1987 Accord, IPKF → post-2009 reconciliation

→ 2022 crisis: ~US$4 bn; co-chaired Official Creditor Committee

→ 2024-25: grid, LNG, UPI, ferries (Dissanayake)

→ Cyclone Ditwah → Op Sagar Bandhu (1,058 t+); $450 mn package




*Palk Strait, Gulf of Mannar*

**Convergence**

→ Trade $7.18 bn (FY26); ETCA talks

→ 60,000 houses; Kankesanthurai $65 mn; Nagapattinam ferry; UPI 2024

→ Sampur solar; HVDC MoU; Trincomalee energy hub (with UAE)

→ Defence MoU 2025; Mitra Shakti, SLINEX; MRCC; CSC

**Divergence**

→ 13th Amendment; Provincial Council polls

→ Katchatheevu (1974, 1976); bottom trawling; Delft firing 2025

→ Adani left Mannar wind

→ Hambantota

**Handout alert:** ISFTA dated 2000 (handout) vs 1998 (slide 35). Write "ISFTA" and check class notes.

## 👥 MALDIVES: "LOCATION, NOT SIZE" PYQ 2024

| 1976 | 1988 | 2004–14 | 2016–23 | 2023 | 2024 | 2025–26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| maritime boundary (slide: 1979) | Op Cactus | tsunami; Op Neer | India First | India Out | civilians; CEMSP | reset |

**Convergence**

→ CEMSP Oct 2024; Ekuverin, Ekatha, Dosti; CSC

→ Trade $771.76 mn; FTA round 1 (Jul 2026)

→ Swap US$400 mn + ₹30 bn; RuPay; Favara–UPI

→ GMCP US$500 mn; Hanimaadhoo runway

→ 60,000 Indians; 1,000 civil servants trained

**Divergence**

→ "India Out" 2023–24; hydrographic pact not renewed

→ Chinese research vessel 2024; UTF Harbour suspicion

→ China–Maldives FTA (Jan 2025)

→ Lakshadweep row (Jan 2024): tourist boycott; 2 lakh+ tourists before

**Close (slide 42):** combine security cooperation with respect for sovereignty under MAHASAGAR; clear rules for Indian assets; Project Mausam. ✅

**In the news · Jul–Aug 2026** MAHASAGAR: India as "preferred security partner and first responder" (Aug CA). Favara–UPI corridor live (Jul CA). ₹4,000-cr LoC to Bhutan; Hasina extradition request renewed (handout, 2026).

## EIGHT NEIGHBOURS IN ONE TABLE

| Neighbour | Slide phrase | China footprint | One fix |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pakistan | Structural rivalry | CPEC, Gwadar | Deterrence + humanitarian channels |
| Afghanistan | Engagement without endorsement | Mes Aynak | Chabahar; small projects |
| Bangladesh | Strategic reset | Submarine facility | Teesta + Ganga 2026 |
| Nepal | Roti–Beti, open border | BRI framework 2024 | 1950 Treaty review |
| Bhutan | B4B | Boundary talks | Beyond hydropower |
| Myanmar | Calibrated engagement | Kyaukphyu | Finish Kaladan |
| Sri Lanka | Crisis → connectivity | Hambantota | Fisheries framework |
| Maldives | Location, not size | FTA, research vessel | Sovereignty-sensitive rules |

## 🎯 PYQ ANSWER FRAMES

| PYQ | Approach | Body |
|---|---|---|
| 🆕 2024 Maldives (15m) | Component + SWOT | Part 1 importance · Part 2 S/W/O/T |
| 2022 Sri Lanka crisis (10m) | Temporal | old ties → 2022 $4 bn → connectivity → limits |
| 2015 Project Mausam (12.5m) | Level analysis | cultural → bilateral → Indian Ocean strategy (thin notes) |
| ⚡ 2015 India–Pak soft power (12.5m) | Stakeholder | people, pilgrims · govts · army, terror → "goodwill follows peace" |

## Recall drill: cover and answer

| | |
|---|---|
| Gujral Doctrine 4 parts? | Non-reciprocity, non-interference, sovereignty, peaceful settlement |
| Pakistan frame? | Deterrence + escalation control + limited engagement |
| IWT western rivers? | Indus, Jhelum, Chenab |
| Afghan phrase? | Engagement without endorsement/ recognition |
| LBA 2015 enclaves? | 111 Indian, 51 Bangladeshi |
| Ganga Treaty expires? | December 2026 |
| Nepal disputed areas? | Kalapani, Lipulekh, Limpiyadhura |
| Bhutan core idea? | Bharat for Bhutan, Bhutan for Bharat |
| Myanmar border length / project? | 1,643 km; Kaladan (Kolkata–Sittwe–Mizoram) |
| Sri Lanka 2022 aid? | ~US$4 bn; creditor committee co-chair |
| Maldives partnership 2024? | CEMSP (October 2024) |

# INDIAN DIASPORA

PYQ Mains 2026 · 2023 · 2020 · 2017 (one every 3 years)

✎ *Indians living abroad are a "living bridge": they send money, ideas and goodwill home. But a bridge can also carry problems: visas, wars and racism become India's problems too.*

Indian diaspora = people whose origins trace to India, or Indian citizens settled abroad. India has the world's largest diaspora: about 37 million (MEA, 2026).
Diaspora diplomacy = building ties with communities abroad and using their networks, knowledge and influence for national interest.

**Who?**

→ NRI → an Indian citizen living abroad
→ OCI → a foreign citizen of Indian origin; lifelong visa; can live, work, study in India (Jul 2026 CA)
→ PIO → Person of Indian Origin
→ Trap: citizenship decides. NRI = citizen, OCI = not.

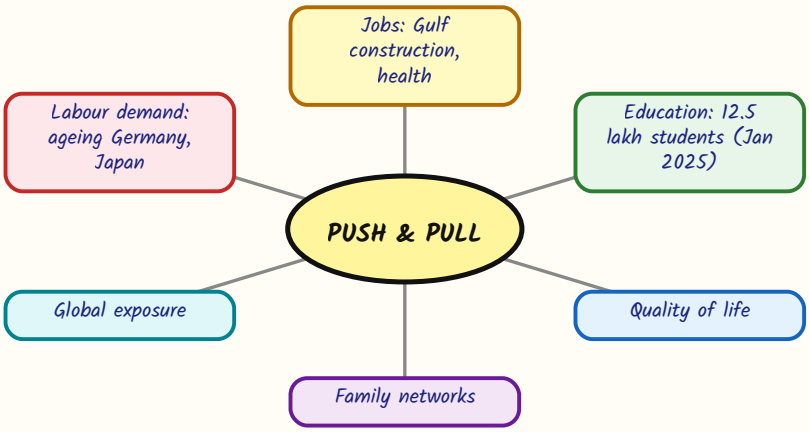
## NEW TOP 5 HOMES (Jan 2026)

| Country | Indians |
|---|---|
| USA | 6.07 mn |
| UAE | 4.34 mn |
| Canada | 3.24 mn |
| Saudi Arabia | 2.75 mn |
| UK | 1.28 mn |

**U-U-C-S-U** – US, UAE, Canada, Saudi, UK: two "U"s first, a "U" last. (own mnemonic, kept in order)

Money vs headcount: the US sends the most remittances (27.7%); the UAE hosts the most workers (4.3 mn+).

## WHY INDIANS MIGRATE




Students abroad (Jan 2025): about 12.5 lakh → Canada 4.27 lakh, Australia 1.96 lakh; also US, UK. UAE alone hosts over 4.3 mn Indians.

## ONE DIASPORA? NO, FOUR

| Segment | Where | What they want |
|---|---|---|
| 💰 Migrant workers | UAE, Saudi, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman; SE Asia | Job security, fair wages, labour rights, safety |
| Professionals & entrepreneurs | US, UK, Europe, Canada, Australia | Careers, investment, tax, mobility |
| Students & researchers | US, UK, Canada, Australia, Europe | Quality education, scholarships, jobs |
| Historic (Girmitiya) | Mauritius, Fiji, Guyana, Suriname, S. Africa, Caribbean | Heritage, identity, culture |

Slide 4 line to quote: "Different groups require different forms of engagement." A Gulf worker, a Silicon Valley founder and a 4th-generation PIO in Mauritius want different things. ⭐

## 🎯 WHY THE DIASPORA MATTERS PYQ 2023 · 2026

**Money**
→ Remittances US$135.4 bn (FY25) = world's highest, ≈ 3.8% of GDP
→ Shares 2023-24: US 27.7%, UAE 19.2%, UK 10.8% → support Kerala, Punjab households
→ Crisis finance: Resurgent India Bonds 1998 → US$4.2 bn (sanctions year); India Development Bonds; India Millennium Deposits

**Business**
→ Venture capital, mentors, market contacts
→ Silicon Valley–India network → SaaS, fintech, deep-tech

**Politics**
→ Explain India's concerns to host governments
→ Indian-American lobby backed the 2008 India–US Civil Nuclear Agreement; Howdy Modi
→ Keeps India informed of global trends

**⚡ Soft power**
→ Diwali, Holi, yoga, cuisine, cinema, Ayurveda
→ Girmitiya links: Mauritius, Fiji, Guyana, Suriname, Trinidad & Tobago, S. Africa

**Knowledge**
→ Tech, medicine, academia, research
→ Leaders: Sunak (UK PM 2022–24), Harris (US VP 2021–25), Pichai, Nadella, Banga (World Bank), Sunita Williams

**Brain drain** ⭐
skilled people leave → human capital lost at home

**Brain circulation** ✅
they return with technology, capital, managerial skill → the policy goal

## 🎯 HOW HERITAGE BECOMES LEVERAGE (2026 PYQ chain)

*Cultural heritage (yoga, festivals)* → *Soft power (goodwill)* → *Influence (lobby, leaders)* → *Strategic leverage (2008 deal, bonds)*

In the news · Jan 2026 MEA on Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (9 Jan 2026): the diaspora is "a living bridge connecting India and the world". Seven months later Mains 2026 used the same words. Lesson: UPSC borrows official phrases. (web, verify dates)

## 🎯 WHERE IT STOPS HELPING — PYQ 2026 "critically"

7 limits (slide 8)

→ Remittances → mostly consumption, housing, health; not automatic investment
→ Trust → bonds and investment need trust in Indian institutions
→ Unequal access → networks informal; small firms can't use them
→ Political limits → Indian-origin legislators serve host-country voters
→ Soft-power limits → culture ≠ diplomatic support
→ Welfare → visas, racism, wars become bilateral issues
→ Security → small sections fund separatism, attack missions

Write "can support", never "will support". Indian origin ≠ pro-India.

In the news · Aug 2026 CA "Diaspora 2.0": the Standing Committee (2022, as quoted) found missions lack a structured way to consult overseas Indians → move from ceremony to partnership on skills, investment and 2nd-generation culture.

## ⚠️ PROBLEMS THE DIASPORA FACES

⚠️ Challenges (slide 9)

→ Old law: Emigration Act 1983 (recruiting agents, Protector General of Emigrants) → outdated
→ Visas: H-1B and other curbs hit IT staff, students
→ Consular: delays, weak access in emergencies
→ Workers: poor pension, social security in some GCC states
→ Conflict: West Asia; evacuation needs host-country help
→ Racism: 400+ Indian student deaths, 2018–24
→ Identity: 2nd generation; loyalty pulls in a dispute

In the news · Jul 2026 CA Russian strike at Odesa killed 10 crew, 4 Indian. US replaced "Duration of Status" with a fixed stay for F, J, I visas. India fell to 125th in the Global Passport Index. (verify dates)

## EVACUATION DIPLOMACY (handout only)

| Raahat 2015 | Ganga 2022 | Kaveri 2023 | Ajay 2023 | Sindhu 2025 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Yemen | Ukraine | Sudan | Israel–Gaza | Iran |
| naval + air | via neighbours | navy, air, diplomacy | return flights | 3,597 from Iran, 818 from Israel |

R-G-K-A-S — "Really Good Kind And Swift" = Raahat, Ganga, Kaveri, Ajay, Sindhu, in date order. (own mnemonic) Don't mix with Devi Shakti (Afghanistan, Ch 3).

## ⚠️ GAPS IN INDIA'S APPROACH

⚠️ Gaps (slide 10 + handout)

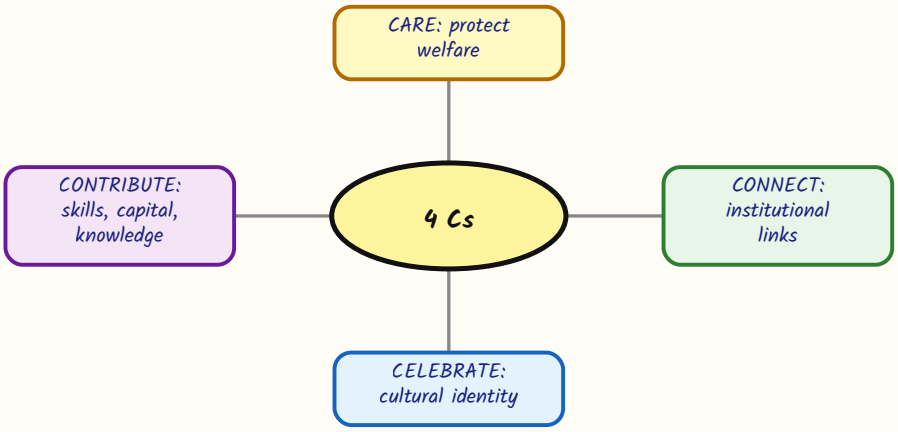
→ No single diaspora policy; no authentic data (Standing Committee 2025)
→ 3,000+ unregistered agents (Oct 2024); weak penalties
→ Contracts hard to enforce abroad; low mission registration
→ Thin consulates; weak MEA–state–recruiter coordination
→ Students pick unverified institutions
→ Overseas Mobility (Facilitation & Welfare) Bill 2024 still pending

## 🔧 WAY FORWARD

**Fix (slide 11)**

→ **Differentiated policy** for workers, students, professionals, researchers
→ **Real-time migration database** (migrants + returnees)
→ **Worker protection:** labour pacts, agent registration with PGE, legal aid, pre-departure training
→ **Consular + digital:** liaison offices, one platform for MEA–states–employers
→ **Talent:** VAIBHAV, VAJRA, GIAN; collaborate without permanent return
→ **Capital:** cheaper transfers, mutual funds, start-up links
→ **Security:** act on unlawful individuals, **not the whole diaspora**

## THE 4 Cs (slide 12)




*PM: the diaspora are "Rashtradoot", India's global brand ambassadors.*

**Conclusion line (slide 12):** India's diaspora policy should move from simple engagement to protection, partnership and productive global networks. ✅

## 🎯 PYQ ANSWER FRAMES

| PYQ | Approach | Body in one line |
|---|---|---|
| 🆕 2026 (15m) living bridge, critically | Level analysis | Household → national → bilateral → global; + and – at each |
| 👫 2023 (10m) benefits in the West | Component | Economic · political · one caveat |
| ⚡ 2020 (10m) "decisive" role? | Stakeholder | Host govts · voters · India → "important, not decisive" |
| ⚡ 2017 (15m) role in SE Asia | PESTEL | Economy · society · politics → limits (thin notes) |

**Handout error:** it prints 2020 as 15 marks; the paper had it at **10 marks, 150 words**. ⭐

## Recall drill: cover and answer

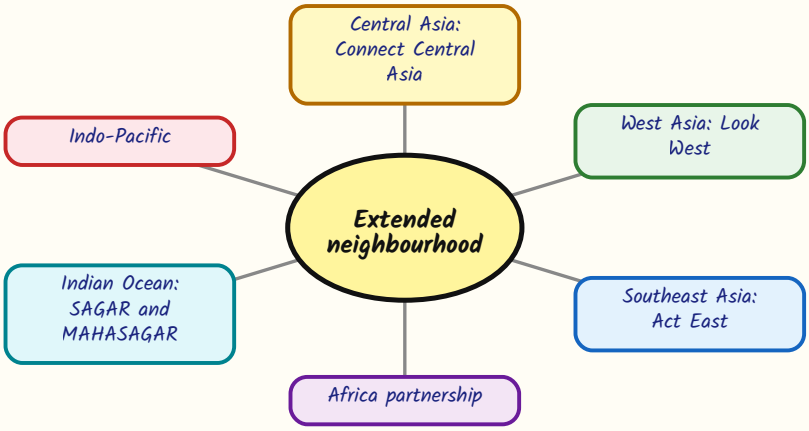
| | |
|---|---|
| NRI or OCI: who is an Indian citizen? | NRI |
| Size and top 3 homes? | ≈37 mn; US 6.07, UAE 4.34, Canada 3.24 mn |
| Remittances FY25? | US$135.4 bn, world's highest, ≈3.8% of GDP |
| Resurgent India Bonds? | 1998, US$4.2 bn, sanctions year |
| Four segments? | Workers, professionals, students, historic |
| Seven limits? | Consumption, trust, access, host loyalty, soft power, welfare, security |
| Five evacuations in order? | Raahat, Ganga, Kaveri, Ajay, Sindhu |
| Pending law? | Overseas Mobility Bill 2024 (replaces Emigration Act 1983) |
| 4 Cs? | Care, Connect, Celebrate, Contribute |
| Closing line? | Engagement → protection, partnership, productive networks |

# EXTENDED NEIGHBOURHOOD

PYQ Mains 2024 · 2021 (x2) · 2018 (x2) · 2016 · 2015

✎ *Six regions beyond South Asia feed India's energy, trade, minerals and security. In every one, India's problem is less intent than delivery.*

## Regions beyond South Asia



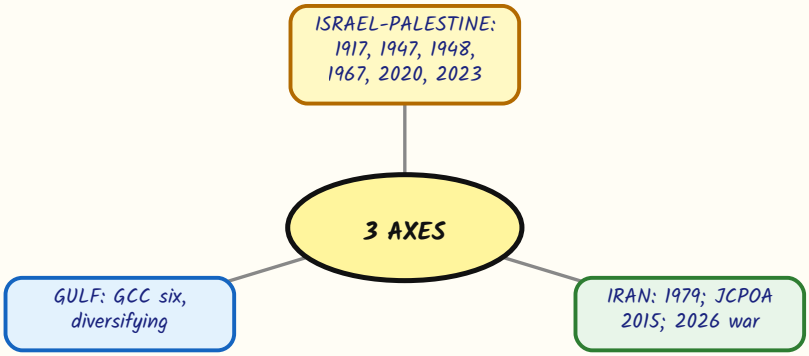

| Direction | Region | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 West | West Asia, Gulf | energy, investment, diaspora |
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 Northwest | Central Asia | connectivity, resources |
| W/SW | Africa | markets, minerals, Global South |
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 East | ASEAN, East Asia | trade, tech, production networks |
| Maritime arc | Indo-Pacific | sea lanes, blue economy |
| Across the Atlantic | Latin America | energy, minerals, markets |

**W-C-A-A-I-L** — "We Can Always Ask India Later" = West Asia, Central Asia, ASEAN, Africa, Indo-Pacific, Latin America. (own mnemonic)

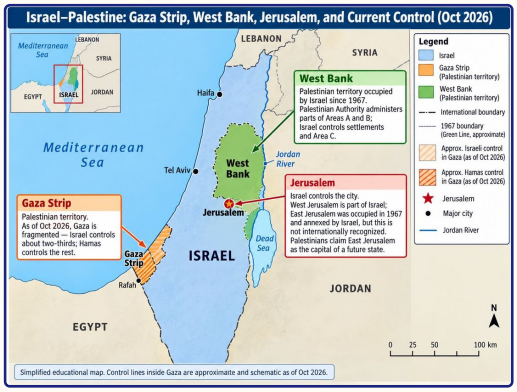
## 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 WEST ASIA: "STRATEGIC ENGAGEMENT WITH CAREFUL BALANCING"

> *"West Asia is part of our extended neighbourhood."* — Jaishankar. India's energy, diaspora, connectivity, maritime corridor: *Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb, Red Sea, Suez*

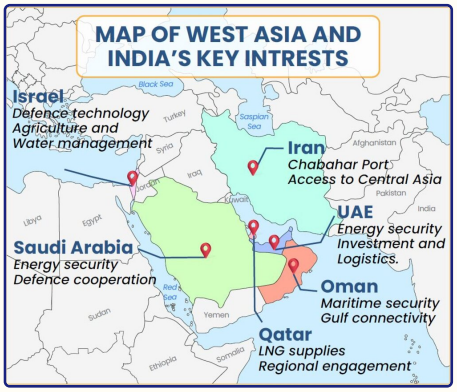
| to 1947 | 1947-70s | 1970s-91 | 1992-2004 | 2005-13 | 2014-19 | 2020-23 | 2023-26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| trade, Sufism | Arab nationalism, Palestine | oil shocks, Gulf migration | Israel ties 1992 | Look West | de-hyphenation | I2U2, IMEC, Abraham Accords | Gaza, Red Sea, Iran war |




**Israel–Palestine:** Balfour 1917 → UN plan 1947 → Israel 1948 → 1967 occupation → Abraham Accords 2020 (UAE, Bahrain) → 7 Oct 2023 → ceasefire 2025. **Iran:** 1979 revolution; JCPOA 2015, US exit 2018; 2026 US–Israel–Iran war hits Hormuz. **GCC:** Saudi, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain; Saudi has not normalised with Israel.




*Israel-Palestine (slide 6)*




*West Asia: India's interests (slide 9)*

**Major powers (slide 8):** US = security actor, stop Iranian bomb · China = energy, BRI; brokered **Saudi–Iran 2023** · Russia = Iran ties, Syria 2015, OPEC+ · **India seeks relations across competing camps.**

**Israel** PYQ 2018

- → Recognised **1950**, full ties **1992**
- → **Barak, Phalcon, Heron**; water, agri, cyber
- → Trade $3.93 bn; FTA round 2 (Jul 2026)
- → **Special Strategic Partnership** (Feb 2026)

**Palestine**

- → **De-hyphenated**
- → PM in **Ramallah 2018** (first)
- → **Two-State solution**
- → Humanitarian aid continues

**Slide phrase:** "Cooperation with Israel without abandoning support for Palestinian statehood" (slide 11).

**Iran**

- → **Chabahar**: bypass Pak; **Shahid Beheshti 10-yr contract (May 2024)**
- → INSTC hub
- → Limits: sanctions, banking, war
- → **Op Sindhu 2025**: 3,597 from Iran, 818 from Israel

**Gulf**

- → GCC trade **$178.56 bn** (FY25); ~**10 mn** Indians
- → **UAE**: CEPA 2022; $101.25 bn; target $200 bn by 2032; rupee-dirham; IMEC
- → **Saudi**: SPC 2019; defence committee 2025
- → **Qatar** LNG · **Oman** Duqm; **CEPA 1 Jun 2026** · GCC FTA talks (Feb 2026)

⚠ Challenges (slide 17)

→ Balancing harder after 2026 US-Israel-Iran war
→ Hormuz, Red Sea → freight, insurance, inflation
→ IMEC slowed; Chabahar sanctioned → need multiple routes
→ Workers: passport retention, recruitment abuse
→ OIC on J&K

Close (slide 18): simultaneous engagement with competing actors; strategic autonomy, diversified partners, secure energy and sea routes, citizen protection without rigid regional alignments. Build both Chabahar and IMEC; more SPR; Op Sankalp. ✅

In the news · Jul-Aug 2026 CA Mecca Joint Defence Agreement (Saudi-Türkiye-Pak); India-Israel BIT in force (first OECD country on the 2015 model); Hormuz "reopen for 60 days", then new routes but no reopening (13 Sep 2026); Houthi blockade at Bab-el-Mandeb; UAE left OPEC (May 2026).

## 🎯 ASEAN: "CONVERGENCE, UNDER-REALISED ECONOMICS" PYQ 2016

*"ASEAN centrality is at the heart of India's Act East Policy" – PM, Vientiane 2024.*
*ASEAN = 11 members (Timor-Leste 2025).*



ASEAN (slide 20)

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1991 | 1992 / 1995 | 2002 / 2010 | 2014 | 2019 | 2022 | 2025-26 |
| Look East | Sectoral → Dialogue | Summit; AITIGA | Act East | IPOI | CSP | Prabowo; Indonesia visit |

Convergence

→ Trade $128.38 bn (~10%); FDI $3.5 bn
→ Trilateral Highway, Kaladan
→ UPI-PayNow (19 banks); 5.9 mn travellers
→ ASEAN Power Grid; Indonesia nickel
→ 2026 Year of Maritime Cooperation; AIME 2026

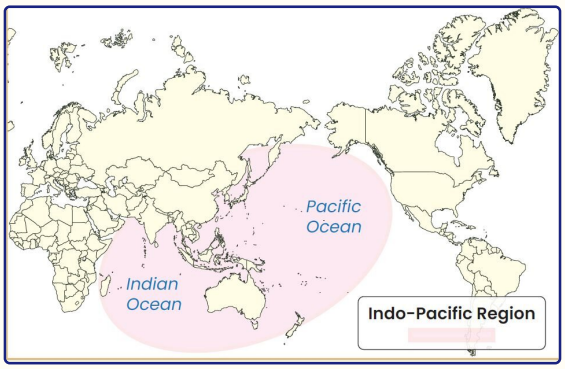
⚠ Challenges

→ Deficit ~$51.55 bn
→ RCEP exit; rules of origin
→ China: ASEAN-China FTA 3.0 (2025)
→ Kaladan, Myanmar delays
→ mineral processing concentrated

Close (slide 24): move from strategic convergence to economic integration, connectivity, maritime cooperation; "beyond ASEAN centrality as a slogan"; Viksit Bharat 2047 + ASEAN 2045. ✅

In the news · Jul-Aug 2026 CA BrahMos for Indonesia (2nd SE Asian buyer); Sabang revived; Indonesian officer at IFC-IOR. China's rules for Scarborough Shoal (2016 award: a rock). 55%+ of India's trade crosses SCS + Malacca.

## INDO-PACIFIC PYQ 2021 AUKUS




Indo-Pacific: E. Africa to the Americas (slide 25)

**Why it matters**

→ Chokepoints: Malacca, Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb
→ Supply chains; Northeast gateway
→ Minerals: Australia, Indonesia
→ A&N near Malacca; IFC-IOR, Op Sankalp

| Who | Preferred order |
|---|---|
| India | free, open, inclusive, multipolar; ASEAN centrality; no formal alliance |
| US | alliances, forward presence, deterrence of China |
| China | against "containment" groupings |
| ASEAN | centrality, no blocs |
| Japan | FOIP |
| Australia | rules + deterrence |

**India's strategy (slide 29)**

→ No formal anti-China bloc; China = dialogue + deterrence + de-risking
→ Link IPOI with ASEAN's AOIP
→ IFC-IOR, satellites; Quad, IORA, ADMM-Plus, EAS, MILAN
→ Minerals: access + processing + refining + recycling

**Thin notes:** AUKUS only named. Frame: AUKUS adds a military-tech layer; inclusive forums India prefers continue → "complement, not replacement". **Handout alert:** "Divzd cooperation..." line garbled.

In the news · Jul 2026 CA + web Mains 2026 asked if IPMDA bridges SAGAR and the Quad. Quad FMM, New Delhi (26 May 2026, web). New Zealand joined IPOI's maritime pillar; Japan aligned FOIP with MAHASAGAR.

## CENTRAL ASIA: "A GEOGRAPHY GAP, NOT AN INTEREST GAP" PYQ 2024 · 2018




Kazakh uranium · Uzbek minerals · Turkmen gas · Kyrgyz education · Tajik security (slide 32)

| 2012 | 2015 | 2017 | 2018 | 2019 | 2022 | 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Connect Central Asia | PM in all 5 | SCO | Ashgabat | Dialogue | 1st Summit | Uzbek CSP |

**Convergence**

→ Uzbek trade $1.3 bn; Rare Earth Forum 2024; Uzbek MoU 2026

→ Kazakh uranium; TAPI (stalled)

→ INSTC cargo to Kazakhstan (Mar 2025)

→ DUSTLIK 2026; Afghanistan, terror, drugs

→ 16,000 students in Kyrgyzstan; all 5 back UNSC bid

**⚠ Challenges**

→ No land route (Pak)

→ China trade $106.3 bn

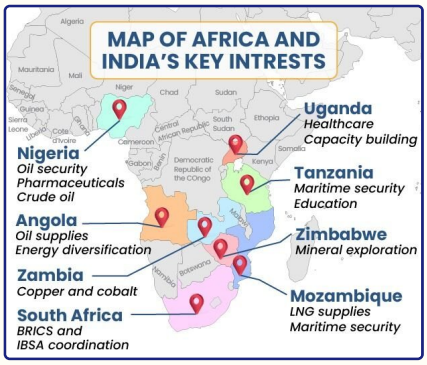
→ Chabahar waiver lapsed (Apr 2026)

→ Afghan militancy; Bishkek 2024 violence

Close (slide 35): "Connect Central Asia 2.0": INSTC + Ashgabat + EAEU FTA (ToR Aug 2025) + SCO. Kazakhstan = largest uranium producer (Jul CA). ✅

## 🎯 AFRICA: "FROM GOODWILL TO DELIVERY" PYQ 2021 · 2015

*"Africa will be at the top of our priorities." – PM, Uganda 2018. Ansari: a "Two-Way street".*




*Africa: India's interests (PPT-7 slide 5)*

| *to 1990s* | *2004* | *2008* | *2018* | *2023* | *2026* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| anti-apartheid, NAM | Pan-African e-Network | IAFS-I | Kampala Principles | AU in G20 | IAFS-IV postponed (Ebola) |

**Convergence**

→ Trade $93.69 bn (slide); AfCFTA 1.3 bn people

→ Minerals: lithium, copper, rare earths

→ Energy: Nigeria, Angola, Mozambique; ISA

→ e-VBAB, ITEC, LoCs

→ AIKEYME 2025; IADD; UNSC reform

**⚠ Gaps**

→ Footprint far below China

→ Pharma quality; standards

→ Many rivals: US, EU, Russia, Türkiye, UAE

→ Sahel, Horn; Op Kaveri 2023

→ Delays; Red Sea; racial attacks in India; W. Africa neglected

Kampala Principles (2018), 10: Africa a priority · African priorities · open markets · share DPI · agriculture · climate · counter-terror + UN peacekeeping · open oceans · no external rivalry · fairer global order.

Close (slide 9): move from goodwill to delivery, aligned with Agenda 2063; regular IAFS; local processing; Africa Growth Fund. ✅

**In the news · Jul-Aug 2026 CA + web** Mains 2025 asked on India-Africa digital partnership; NPCI-Bank of Namibia UPI licence (Jul 2025, web). India-SACU PTA terms signed; Chad leaving the ICC.

## LATIN AMERICA & CARIBBEAN




*LAC: India's interests (PPT-7 slide 13)*

**Story**

→ Indentured diaspora: Guyana, T&T, Suriname
→ PTAs: MERCOSUR, Chile (2006); CELAC
→ KABIL lithium, Argentina; 2nd CARICOM summit
→ 2025–26 visits: T&T, Argentina, Brazil

**Convergence**

→ Brazil trade $15.21 bn; Chile CEPA talks
→ India–Brazil minerals MoU 2026; ethanol, Global Biofuels Alliance
→ G4 (India–Brazil); IBSA, BRICS
→ 1,000 ITEC slots for CARICOM; Hurricane Melissa relief

**⚠️ Gaps**

→ Mexico tariffs up to 50% (2026)
→ China–LAC $549 bn
→ Distance, Panama Canal
→ Argentina, Mexico in Uniting for Consensus
→ Language; Venezuela crisis

Close (slide 16): logistics, reliable projects, resilient chains can turn distance into partnership. "Commercially promising but strategically underdeveloped" (handout). Target $100 bn trade; Peru FTA, Chile CEPA. ✅

## SIX REGIONS IN ONE TABLE

| Region | Phrase | India trade | China comparison |
|---|---|---|---|
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 West Asia | careful balancing | GCC $178.56 bn | Gulf energy, BRI |
| ASEAN | under-realised economics | $128.38 bn | ASEAN–China FTA 3.0 |
| Indo-Pacific | inclusive, no bloc | — | grey-zone, ports |
| Central Asia | geography gap | Uzbek $1.3 bn | $106.3 bn |
| Africa | goodwill → delivery | $93.69 bn | far ahead |
| Latin America | distance → partnership | Brazil $15.21 bn | $549 bn |

## 🎯 PYQ ANSWER FRAMES

| PYQ | Approach | Body |
|---|---|---|
| 🆕 2024 Central Asia (10m) | Component | diplomatic · economic · strategic · significance · critically |
| 2021 India in Africa (10m*) | PESTEL | AU in G20 · trade · ITEC · DPI · ISA → China gap |
| 2021 AUKUS (15m) | Level analysis | bilateral → regional → global → verdict |
| 2018 Israel "rolled back" (10m) | Temporal | 1950 → 1992 → 2026 SSP → limits |
| 2018 Ashgabat (10m) | Supply chain | port → INSTC → Central Asia, gains + risks |
| 🧑‍🤝‍🧑 2016 Look East (12.5m) | Temporal | 1991–2010 · 2014–19 · 2022–26 → verdict |
| 2015 Africa pros, cons | SWOT | S · W · O · T → net positive if delivered |

Handout errors: 2018 Israel question says "rolled back" (handout: "overlooked"); 2021 Africa = 10 marks (handout: 15). ⭐

## Recall drill: cover and answer

| | |
|---|---|
| Six regions mnemonic? | WCAAIL |
| Three West Asia axes? | Israel–Palestine, Iran, Gulf |
| Israel ties: recognised / full? | 1950 / 1992 |
| Shahid Beheshti contract? | 10 years, May 2024 |
| India–Oman CEPA in force? | 1 June 2026 |
| ASEAN deficit? | ~US$51.55 bn |
| India on China in Indo-Pacific? | Dialogue + deterrence + de-risking |
| Central Asia phrase? | Geography gap, not interest gap |
| Kampala Principles year? | 2018 (10 principles) |
| Africa close? | Goodwill → delivery, Agenda 2063 |
| China–LAC trade? | ~US$549 bn (2025) |